LADY WESTON: Richard, if you are going to shoot off that thing, you will please wait until I –

(*She is interrupted by a loud knocking on the front door downstairs. This is such an unexpected development that all there are momentarily quite still, at a loss. ROGER is the first to recover*).

ROGER: Someone at the front door.

(*He moves over to the window in the rear wall, from which one can see the street. He is about to open the casement so that he may lean out to inspect the knocker, when LORD WESTON stops him.*)

WESTON (*still at the fireplace*): Don't open that window!

ROGER: But I cannot see otherwise, my lord, who it is.

WESTON: If you put your head out of that window, they may shoot without waiting to ask questions.

LADY WESTON: But, Richard, it may be some perfectly innocent visitor.

(*The knocking is repeated.*)

ROGER: If I were to stand on a chair….. (*He brings a chair to the window and stands on it, but he is still not high enough to look down on whoever waits at the front door*).

WESTON: Well? Well? Can you tell who it is?

ROGER: I am still not high enough, my lord.

LADY WESTON: Add the footstool, Roger.

(*Roger adds the footstool to the chair, and aided by LADY WESTON climbs on to the precarious erection*).

LADY WESTON: Now, can you see anyone?

ROGER (*having seen, scrambling downing*): All is well, my lord.

(*He throws open the casement, and calls to someone below*):

It is only Mr. Caesar. (*As this information is succeeded by a blank pause*) Shall I let him in?

WESTON: Who did you say?

ROGER: Mr. Caesar. You remember: the man you met on Tuesday at Hampton, my lord. He was to come to see you this morning about rose trees. You made a note of it.

WESTON (*taking the crumpled piece of paper from his pocket in a dazed way*): I made a note? '***Remember Caesar***'. Is that my writing? Yes, it must be – Dear me!

LADY WESTON (*kindly*): I shouldn't have said it was the venomous scribbling of an illiterate. You had better go down and let Mr Caesar in, Roger. Put the pistol away, Richard, dear; your visitor might misunderstand it. (*She speaks cheerfully, as to a child; it is obvious from her lack of surprise that* ***excursions and alarms*** *created by her husband over trifles are a normal part of existence for her*).

WESTON: Mr Caesar. (*He moves towards the bucket.*)

LADY WESTON: Of course. How could anyone forget a name like that? And now if you'll forgive me….. It's my busy morning.

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